Day 63 - Slough of Despond

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 82 · Slough of Despond, Georgian Bluffs

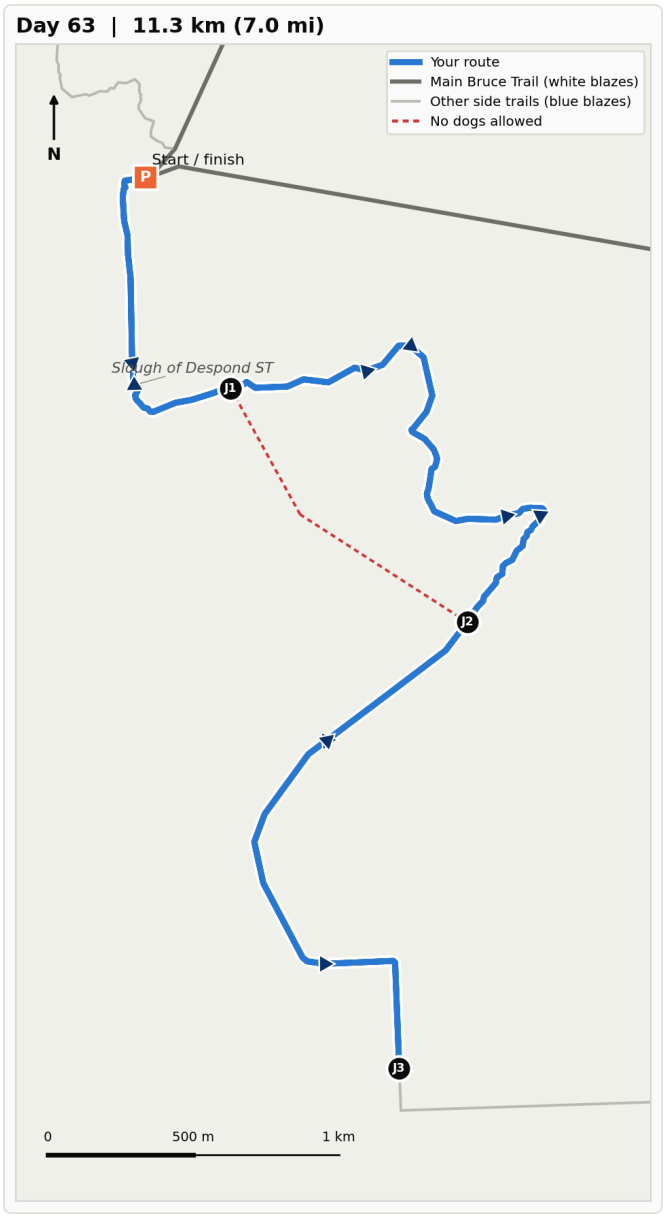
11.3 km / 7.0 mi	~3.6 h	5.7 km new	186 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking on Colpoy's Range Rd. Do not park in the gateway or the loading ramp. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day63_hike082.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Slough of Despond Side Trail (5.7 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside parking on Colpoy's Range Rd. Don't park in the gateway or on the loading ramp. A BTC hike listing calls trailhead parking *limited*. In 2020, a trip report found the eastern part of Colpoy's Range Rd partly flooded and impassable for ordinary cars, so come from the west if it's wet.
- **Slough of Despond Side Trail:** An out-and-back on one long side trail, about 11.4 km in total. A BTC hike listing describes the area as relatively flat through fields and forest, with some crevices and "magnificent views of the bay and Slough of Despond."
- **Stiles:** That BTC loop hike also mentions three stiles with no way around. If you meet stiles, be ready to help Zappy over.
- **The Slough:** A cattail-fringed wetland that a trip report says was left behind when glacial Lake Algonquin was cut off about 11,000 years ago. From Cole's Sideroad you can look west across it to Esther's Bluff.
- **Flooding:** In April 2026 the BTC closed the main trail between Big Bay Sideroad and the Colpoy's Range Rd parking because of flooding, then reopened it on April 29. Expect wet ground in spring and after heavy rain.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions

0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on Colpoy's Range Rd. Head west on the blue-blazed Slough of Despond Side Trail.
1.2	0.8	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Slough of Despond Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed President's Path goes off on your right (NO DOGS on it).)
3.5	2.1	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Slough of Despond Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed President's Path goes off on your right (NO DOGS on it).)
5.0	3.1	Heads-up: The next 1.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
5.7	3.5	J3: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
7.8	4.9	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Slough of Despond Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed President's Path goes off on your left (NO DOGS on it).)
10.1	6.3	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Slough of Despond Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed President's Path goes off on your left (NO DOGS on it).)
11.3	7.0	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Bruce Trail Conservancy notices and hike listings and a Holmstrom Ruddick trip report.